

Leave Policy

Company: DT

Document Type: Leave Policy

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Owner: Human Resources

Review Frequency: Annual

1. Leave Types and Entitlements

DT provides a comprehensive leave structure calculated based on the calendar year (January 1 to December 31). Total annual leave days for full-time employees are divided into four categories: Earned Leave, Casual Leave, Sick Leave, and Optional/Holiday Leave.

1.1. Earned Leave (EL)

- **Annual Quota:** 15 days per year (accrued at 1.25 days per month).
- **Eligibility:** All full-time employees.
- **Carry-Forward:** Up to a maximum of 30 days can be carried forward to the next calendar year. Any Earned Leave balance above 30 days on December 31 will automatically lapse.
- **Encashment:** Allowed only at the time of separation (resignation/termination) on the basic salary component. Encashment during active employment is not permitted.
- **Notice Requirement:** Minimum 14 days of advance notice is required for taking 3 or more consecutive days of EL. For less than 3 days, a 48-hour notice is required.

1.2. Sick Leave (SL)

- **Annual Quota:** 12 days per year (credited upfront on January 1).
- **Eligibility:** All full-time and part-time employees (prorated).
- **Carry-Forward:** Sick Leave cannot be carried forward. Unused balances lapse on December 31.
- **Encashment:** Not allowed.
- **Notice Requirement:** Must be applied for on the day of the illness or retroactively within 24 hours of resuming work.
- **Medical Documentation:** A registered medical practitioner's certificate is mandatory if Sick Leave is taken for 3 or more consecutive days.

1.3. Casual Leave (CL)

- **Annual Quota:** 7 days per year (credited upfront on January 1).
- **Eligibility:** All employees.
- **Carry-Forward:** Casual Leave cannot be carried forward.
- **Encashment:** Not allowed.
- **Notice Requirement:** Minimum 2 days of advance notice. CL cannot be taken for more than 2 consecutive days.

1.4. Holidays and Optional Leave

- **Company Holidays:** DT observes 10 mandatory public holidays per year, determined by the respective state governments of the Bangalore, Chennai, and Hyderabad offices.
- **Optional Leaves:** Employees receive 2 Optional Leave days per year to observe regional or religious festivals not covered in the mandatory list. These do not carry forward.

2. Leave Application and Approval Workflow

2.1. How to Apply

All leave must be applied for through the DT HR Portal. Email or chat requests do not constitute formal leave application, though they may be used for immediate notification.

2.2. Approval Authority

All leaves must be approved by the employee's direct Manager. Managers are required to approve or reject leave requests within 48 hours of submission.

2.3. Emergency Leave Procedure

In cases of severe emergency (e.g., family death, accident), employees must inform their Manager via phone or chat immediately. The formal leave application in the HR Portal can be completed post-event, within 3 days of returning to work.

3. Joining During the Middle of the Year

Employees joining after January 1 will receive a prorated leave balance based on their exact date of joining.

Calculation: If an employee joins on July 1, they will receive 6 Sick Leaves, 3.5 Casual Leaves, and will begin accruing Earned Leave at 1.25 days per month.

4. Examples of Leave Policy Application

- **Example 1: Insufficient Balance**

Scenario: An employee has 0 Sick Leave days remaining but falls ill for 2 days.

Rule: The employee must apply for Casual Leave or Earned Leave. If those balances are also 0, the days will be marked as Leave Without Pay (LWP).

- **Example 2: Carry-Forward Limit**

Scenario: An employee has 34 unused Earned Leave days at the end of the year.

Rule: Only up to 30 days may be carried forward. The remaining 4 days will lapse and cannot be encashed.

- **Example 3: Consecutive Leave**

Scenario: An employee wishes to take 4 days of Casual Leave for a vacation.

Rule: This request will be rejected. Casual Leave cannot exceed 2 consecutive days. The employee must apply for Earned Leave instead.

- **Example 4: Medical Documentation**

Scenario: An employee takes Sick Leave from Monday through Wednesday (3 days) and returns on Thursday.

Rule: Because the sick leave duration reached 3 consecutive days, the employee must upload a doctor's medical certificate to the HR portal; otherwise, the leave will be converted to Leave Without Pay.